

Compile-time Type Checking

In the case of compile-time type checking, it is advisable that it should be used in the case of larger projects, as in such projects it becomes more important to catch type errors than to concentrate on data type flexibility. It is for this reason that the compiler used in Flash ActionScripting is set to run in strict mode.

Consider the following code snippet. Here the code adds data type information to the xParam parameter, and declares a variable myParam with an explicit data type:

```
function runtimeTest(xParam:String)
{
    trace(xParam);
}
var myParam:String = "hello";
runtimeTest(myParam);
```

Run-time Type Checking

Whether a program is run under strict or standard mode, run type checking is always executed. The following example shows a function named typecast which expects an array argument but receives a value 3. Parsing of this value generates a run time error in standard mode as 3 does not belong to the parameters declared for data type Array.

```
function typeCast() (xParam:Array)
{
    trace(xParam);
}
var myNum:Number = 3;
typeCast() (myNum); // run-time error in
ActionScript standard mode
```

2.5 Built In Classes

In Flash ActionScript, class plays a major role, as every object is defined by it. Class is often thought of as a template for an object